

Decision 000 – The First Principle

Project: Ghostrader

Decision ID: 000

Status: Permanent Foundational Principle

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

No feature, design change, technology choice, or new idea will be added to Ghostrader unless it directly supports one or more of the following:

1. The Mission
2. The Target Customer
3. The Current Phase of the Roadmap

If it does not satisfy at least one of these criteria, it will not be built now. Instead, it will be documented in the Feature Backlog for future evaluation.

Why This Decision Exists

Software projects rarely fail because of a lack of ideas.

They fail because of:

- Feature creep
- Constant changes in direction
- Loss of focus
- Technical debt
- Building for everyone instead of one customer
- Solving problems that customers don't actually have

Ghostrader will avoid these pitfalls by making every decision through the lens of our mission.

The Three Filters

Filter 1 – Mission

Does this make Ghostrader a better AI-powered investing platform for beginner investors?

If **No** → Do not build it.

Filter 2 – Customer

Will this make life easier, simpler, or more valuable for our target customer?

If **No** → Do not build it.

Filter 3 – Roadmap

Does this belong in the current phase?

If **No** → Move it to the Feature Backlog.

Our Default Answer

The default answer to every new feature request is:

"Not yet."

The burden of proof is on the feature to justify why it belongs in the current phase.

Every Feature Must Answer Five Questions

Before any work begins, we will ask:

1. What problem does this solve?
2. Who benefits from it?
3. Why is it needed now?
4. Does it fit the current roadmap?
5. Is this the highest-value use of our development time?

If any answer is unclear, the feature will be postponed.

Guiding Philosophy

Focus creates great software.

Ghostrader will not try to be everything.

It will strive to become the best platform for helping beginner investors understand the market with confidence.

Every line of code should move us closer to that goal.

Amendment Policy

This principle may only be changed if overwhelming evidence demonstrates that following it would prevent Ghostrader from achieving its mission.

Otherwise, Decision 000 remains permanent.